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Pathfinder: Awesome Ancient Egypt!

**A Journey Through the Land of the
Pharaohs**

Grade Level: 5th Grade

Subject: Social Studies & Language Arts



Table of Contents

- Introduction.....Page 3
- Your Mission: Project Choices.....Page 4
- Finding Books: RDA Clues.....Page 5
- Finding Books: Super Subject Headings.....Page 6
- Finding Books: The Dewey Decimal System.....Page 7
- Finding Websites: MARC Tags.....Page 8
- Searching Our Library Catalog (OPAC).....Page 9
- Can't Find It? Use Inter-Library Loan (ILL)!.....Page 10
- Community Resources.....Page 11
- Digital Resources: Databases & Websites.....Page 12
- Digital Resources: Videos.....Page 13
- Print Resources: Non-Fiction.....Page 14
- Print Resources: Fiction.....Page 15
- Working Together (For the Teacher).....Page 16
- Exploring Different Perspectives.....Page 17
- Standards: AASL.....Page 18
- Standards: Common Core ELA.....Page 19

Welcome Explorers!

Get ready to travel back in time to the amazing world of Ancient Egypt! You'll be a history detective, uncovering the secrets of pharaohs, pyramids, and mummies. This pathfinder is your treasure map to find all the information you need for your project.

For thousands of years, the Egyptian civilization flourished along the banks of the Nile River. They built incredible monuments, developed a unique form of writing, and created a complex society that still fascinates us today.

In this pathfinder, you will learn how to find books, websites, and other resources to help you become an expert on Ancient Egypt. You will use your research skills to learn about a topic that interests you and then share what you've learned with your classmates. Let's start our adventure!

Project Choices

Your mission, should you choose to accept it, is to become an expert on one part of Ancient Egypt. You could research:

- The Great Pyramids and how they were built.
- Mummies and why the Egyptians made them.
- King Tutankhamun (King Tut) and the treasures in his tomb.
- Hieroglyphics, the cool picture-writing of the Egyptians.
- Daily life for kids in Ancient Egypt.
- The role of the Nile River in Egyptian life.
- Egyptian gods and goddesses.
- Famous pharaohs like Hatshepsut or Ramses the Great.

Once you have gathered your facts, you'll share what you learned in one of these fun ways:

- **A Google Slideshow:** Teach the class about your topic with cool pictures and fun facts. Your slideshow should have at least 10 slides.
- **A "Did You Know?" Poster:** Create a colorful poster with at least 5 amazing facts about your topic. Be sure to include illustrations!
- **An "Expert" Commercial:** Film a short video (1-2 minutes) where you pretend to be an expert and tell us all about your topic.
- **A Diorama:** Build a 3D scene of your topic in a shoebox. Write a one-paragraph explanation of your diorama.
- **A Research Report:** Write a one-page report about your topic. Be sure to include a list of your sources.

RDA Clues

When librarians add a new book to the library, they use special clues to describe it. This is called Resource Description and Access (RDA). Think of it like a character sheet for a book! Here are some RDA clues for a book you might like:

Example:

Title: Magic Tree House: Mummies in the Morning

Author: Osborne, Mary Pope

Content Type: Text (it's a book for reading!)

Media Type: Unmediated (you don't need a computer to read it)

Carrier Type: Volume (it's a physical book)

Publication Date: 1993

Illustrator: Sal Murdocca

Extent of Item: 68 pages

Series: Magic Tree House, No. 3

Understanding these clues can help you decide if a book is right for your project before you even pull it off the shelf!



Super Subject Headings

LC Subject Heading Examples:

Try these Sears Subject Headings in the catalog:

- Egypt--History--To 332 B.C.
- Tombs--Egypt

- Egypt--Civilization

- **Related Heading:** *Mythology, Egyptian* (for stories about gods and goddesses)
- **Broader Heading:** *Civilization, Ancient* (for books about other ancient cultures)
- **Narrower Heading:** *Hieroglyphics* (for books specifically about Egyptian writing)

- Pyramids

- **Related Heading:** *Mummies*

- Pharaohs

- **Excavations (Archaeology)--Egypt** (for books about discovering tombs and temples)

You might also see **Library of Congress (LC) Subject Headings** in other catalogs, like the public library's. They are more detailed.



The Dewey Decimal System

Our library uses the **Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC)** system to organize books on the shelves. It's like a street address for a book! You can walk right to the section you need.

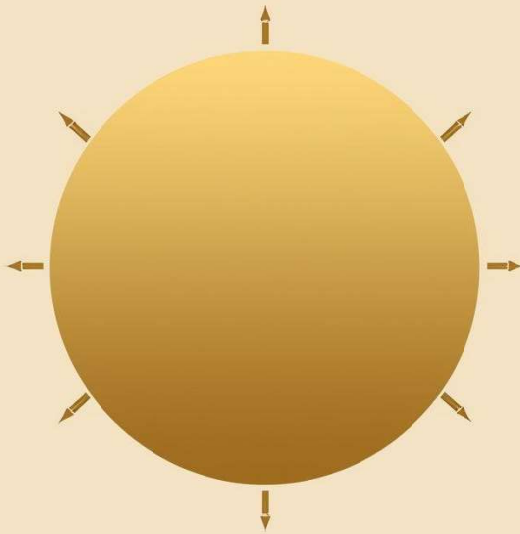
The main number for Ancient Egypt is **932**. When you go to the **900s** section of the library, look for the numbers on the spines of the books. All the books about Ancient Egyptian history will be together under **932**.

You can also browse nearby numbers for related topics:

- **Main Number: 932** - History of Ancient Egypt
- **Related Number: 709.32** - Art of Ancient Egypt
- **Related Number: 393.3** - Mummies and burial customs
- **Related Number: 299.31** - Egyptian mythology and religion

Don't be afraid to explore the shelves. You might discover a book you didn't even know you were looking for!

MARC Tags



MARC (Machine-Readable Cataloging) tags are secret codes that librarians use to put information into the computer catalog. One of the most helpful tags is the 856 tag, which creates a clickable link to a website!

When you see a blue, underlined link in a catalog record, that's an 856 tag at work. It's a shortcut to a website that the librarian has already checked and knows is a good source of information.

Here's what an 856 tag looks like in the catalog:

Electronic Access: [Click here for a great website about Ancient Egypt for kids!](http://www.historyforkids.net/ancient-egypt.html)

And here's the MARC code that makes it happen:

856 40 |u <http://www.historyforkids.net/ancient-egypt.html> Click here for a great website about Ancient Egypt for kids!

Another helpful MARC tag is the **520 tag**, which gives you a summary of the resource. This can help you decide if a book or website is what you're looking for.

520 ## |a This website provides an overview of ancient Egyptian history, including information on pharaohs, pyramids, and daily life.

Searching Our Library Catalog (OPAC)

The library catalog, or OPAC (Online Public Access Catalog), is your best friend for finding resources. Here are two tricks to make your search even better:

1. Boolean Searching: This sounds fancy, but it's easy! Use the words AND, OR, and
2. NOT to connect your search words.
 - AND narrows your search.
 - Example: "mummies AND king tut" will find resources that discuss both.
 - OR broadens your search.
 - Example: "pyramids OR tombs" will find resources about either topic.
 - NOT excludes words from your search.
 - Example: "Egypt NOT modern" will give you results about ancient Egypt, not today's Egypt.
3. Filter Your Results: After you search, you can use the filters on the side of the page to narrow down your choices. You can pick:
 - Format: Book, ebook, video, etc.
 - Location: To see what's available in our library right now.
 - Reading Level: To find books that are just right for you.
 - Publication Date: To find the newest books.

Can't Find It? Use Inter- Library Loan (ILL)

If you can't find the perfect book in our library, don't worry! We can borrow it from another library. This is called **Inter-Library Loan (ILL)**.

1. **Other Schools in Our District:** We can search the catalogs of all the other schools in our district. If another school has the book you need, we can have it sent here for you to check out. It usually takes a few days to arrive.
2. **Public Library:** You can use your public library card to borrow from a huge collection of books, ebooks, and databases. You can place a hold on a book through the public library's website and have it sent to your local branch for pickup. It's like a library superpower!

Don't be shy about asking for help with ILL. The librarian is here to help you get the resources you need, no matter where they are!

Community Resources

Learning doesn't just happen in the library! Check out these other places for information:

- The Walters Art Museum (Baltimore, MD): Just a car ride away, this museum has a real Egyptian art collection, including sarcophagi, jewelry, and even a mummy! Seeing the artifacts in person is an unforgettable experience.
 - Website: The crown icon embodies the authority and divinity of pharaohs, serving as a powerful symbol of leadership and governance in ancient Egyptian society, enhancing the educational context.
- The Johns Hopkins Archaeological Museum (Baltimore, MD): This museum on the Johns Hopkins University campus also has a collection of Egyptian artifacts.
 - Website: John's Hopkins Archaeological Site
- Your Local Public Library: The public library has a larger collection of books and databases than our school library. They also have librarians who are experts at helping students with research projects.
- Guest Speakers: Do you know anyone who has traveled to Egypt? Or an expert on ancient history? They could be a great person to interview for your project!



Digital Resources: Databases & Websites

These online resources have been selected just for you! They are reliable, easy to use, and full of great information.



Databases (Ask the librarian for the password!)

- World Book Kids: A great place to start your research. It has articles, images, and videos on almost every topic.
- PebbleGo: Perfect for finding basic facts about animals, historical figures, and more.
- BrainPOP: Watch animated movies about Ancient Egypt, then take a quiz to test your knowledge.

Websites

- National Geographic Kids - Ancient Egypt:
The quill and scroll represent the value of literacy in Ancient Egypt, symbolizing the recording of history, knowledge, and administration that shaped their society.
 - This site has awesome videos, games, and articles all about Ancient Egypt. It's a super fun way to learn!
 - DK Find Out! - Ancient Egypt: The quill and scroll represent the value of literacy in Ancient Egypt, symbolizing the recording of history, knowledge, and administration that shaped their society. Explore Ancient Egypt through amazing pictures and easy-to-read facts.
- The British Museum - Ancient Egypt:
The quill and scroll represent the value of literacy in Ancient Egypt, symbolizing the recording of history, knowledge, and administration that shaped their society.
 - This website from a world-famous museum has tons of information and pictures of real artifacts.

Digital Resources: Videos

Sometimes the best way to learn is by watching! Here are some great videos to get you started on your research.

Ancient Egypt for Kids

https://youtu.be/zYxC14pCaJ0?si=cknwkl2Cutrt_wie

A fun overview of Ancient Egyptian history.

National Geographic: Ancient Egypt 101

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hO1tzmi1V5g_

A more detailed video that covers the history of Ancient Egypt from start to finish.

Ted-Ed - The pharaoh that wouldn't be forgotten:

https://youtu.be/8bYRy_wZEJI?si=hqnVFBI-KU2ig2QX

A beautifully animated video about the female pharaoh Hatshepsut.

Free School - Mummification:

https://youtu.be/Gg8254OKt_s?si=pC3kOvtiKGT1-7_M

A kid friendly explanation of the mummification process.

Remember to be a critical viewer! Think about who made the video and why. The videos listed here are from reliable sources, but not everything on YouTube is

Print Sources: Non-Fiction

Sometimes the best information is still found in a good old-fashioned book! Here are some of the best non-fiction books about Ancient Egypt in our library.

- *Ancient Egypt: Tales of Gods and Pharaohs*
 - **Author:** Marcia Williams
 - **Call Number:** 932 WIL
 - **Summary:** A fun, comic-book-style introduction to Egyptian myths and history.
- *Everything Ancient Egypt*
 - **Author:** Crispin Boyer
 - **Call Number:** 932 BOY
 - **Summary:** A National Geographic Kids book packed with amazing photos and fun facts.
- *You Wouldn't Want to Be a Pyramid Builder!*
 - **Author:** Jacqueline Morley
 - **Call Number:** 932 MOR
 - **Summary:** A funny and informative look at what life was like for the people who built the pyramids.
- *The Great Pyramid*
 - **Author:** Elizabeth Mann
 - **Call Number:** 932 MAN
 - **Summary:** A detailed look at how the Great Pyramid of Giza was built, with beautiful illustrations.
- *Secrets of the Mummies*
 - **Author:** Harriet Griffey
 - **Call Number:** 393.3 GRI
 - **Summary:** A DK Eyewitness book that takes you inside the world of mummies and tombs.

Print Resources: Fiction

Reading stories set in Ancient Egypt can be a great way to imagine what life was like back then. Check out these fun fiction books!

- *Magic Tree House: Mummies in the Morning*
 - **Author:** Mary Pope Osborne
 - **Call Number:** F OSB
 - **Summary:** Jack and Annie travel back in time to Ancient Egypt and explore a pyramid.
 - *The Red Pyramid*
 - **Author:** Rick Riordan
 - **Call Number:** F RIO
 - **Summary:** Two siblings discover they are descended from Egyptian pharaohs and must save the world from an ancient god.
 - *The Egypt Game*
 - **Author:** Zilpha Keatley Snyder
 - **Call Number:** F SNY
 - **Summary:** A group of kids creates their own "Egypt" in an abandoned lot and gets caught up in a mystery.
 - *Mara, Daughter of the Nile*
 - **Author:** Eloise Jarvis McGraw
 - **Call Number:** F MCG
 - **Summary:** A thrilling story of a young slave girl who becomes a spy in the court of the pharaoh.
-

Working Together (For the teacher)

This project is a team effort between the School Librarian, the 5th-grade Social Studies teacher, and the 5th-grade Language Arts teacher.

Social Studies Connection

- This project fits perfectly with the 5th-grade curriculum on ancient civilizations. The librarian can help students learn how to be good researchers by teaching lessons on:
 - Evaluating sources for reliability and bias.
 - Taking effective notes and avoiding plagiarism.
 - Citing sources in a simple format.

Language Arts Connection

- The final project helps students practice their writing, research, and presentation skills, all part of the ELA standards. The ELA teacher can provide instruction on:
 - Formulating research questions.
 - Organizing research into a logical structure.
 - Writing for a specific audience and purpose.

Collaboration

- The librarian and classroom teachers can work together to schedule library time, co-teach lessons, and assess student projects. The librarian can also pull a collection of books and create a display to generate excitement about the project.

Exploring Different Perspectives

History is more than just kings and queens!
As you research, think about these things:

Life as a Kid: What was it like to be a kid in Ancient Egypt? Try to find information about what children did for fun, what their school was like, and what chores they had to do.

Awesome Women: Cleopatra wasn't the only powerful woman in Egypt! Look for information about other female pharaohs like Hatshepsut or influential goddesses like Isis.

Ordinary People: What was life like for a farmer, a soldier, or an artist in Ancient Egypt? How was their life different from a pharaoh's?

Challenging Stereotypes: Have you seen mummies in movies or cartoons? Are they always scary monsters? The Egyptians believed mummification was a sacred process to help people reach the afterlife. How does this change your perspective?

By looking at history from different viewpoints, we can get a more complete and interesting picture of the past.

AASL Standards:

Standards: AASL

This project aligns with the **American Association of School Librarians (AASL) Standards Framework for Learners.**

Inquire:

- **A.I.1:** Learners display curiosity and initiative by formulating questions about a personal interest or a curricular topic.
- **A.II.1:** Learners adopt a discerning stance toward points of view and opinions expressed in information resources and object to misinformation.
- **A.III.3:** Learners engage in inquiry-based processes for personal and academic growth.
Include:
- **B.I.1:** Learners demonstrate an understanding of and commitment to inclusiveness and respect for diversity in the learning community.

Collaborate:

- **C.I.1:** Learners demonstrate their ability to work on a team to contribute to a learning community, showing respect for a variety of viewpoints and cultural backgrounds.

Curate:

- **D.I.1:** Learners act on an information need by identifying possible sources of information.
- **D.I.2:** Learners demonstrate mastery of technology tools to access information and pursue inquiry.

Explore:

- **E.II.1:** Learners identify and rebel against censorship and infringements on intellectual freedom.

Engage:

- **F.I.1:** Learners follow ethical and legal guidelines for gathering and using information by responsibly applying information, technology, and media to learning.

ELA Standards:

Standards: Common Core ELA

This project aligns with the **Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts** for 5th Grade.

Reading: Informational Text

- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.RI.5.1:** Quote accurately from a text when explaining what the text says explicitly and when drawing inferences from the text.
- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.RI.5.7:** Draw on information from multiple print or digital sources, demonstrating the ability to locate an answer to a question quickly or to solve a problem efficiently.
- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.RI.5.9:** Integrate information from several texts on the same topic in order to write or speak about the subject knowledgeably.

Writing

- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.7:** Conduct short research projects that use several sources to build knowledge through investigation of different aspects of a topic.
- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.5.8:** Recall relevant information from experiences or gather relevant information from print and digital sources; summarize or paraphrase information in notes and finished work, and provide a list of sources.

Speaking & Listening

- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.SL.5.4:** Report on a topic or text or present an opinion, sequencing ideas logically and using appropriate facts and relevant, descriptive details to support main ideas or themes; speak clearly at an understandable pace.
- **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.SL.5.5:** Include multimedia components (e.g., graphics, sound) and visual displays in presentations when appropriate to enhance the development of main ideas or themes.

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